

PRAYER PLANT

Maranta leuconeura

At 16, I got a job in a garden center and bought this plant with my first paycheck. I was captivated by its delightful foliage, whose sweeping scarlet veins looked hand painted. And when the leaves closed up each night, it felt like having a true living companion.

“My folding patterned leaves will enchant you.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

Place out of direct sunlight and drafts. Ideally keep in a high-humidity room; otherwise, mist leaves regularly in summer.



POTTING

Repot to the next size up when the roots grow through the bottom of the container or in circles inside. Use a standard potting compost.



GROWTH RATE

Can reach a height and width of 1ft (30cm). Give leaves an occasional prune just above a leaf node to encourage bushier regrowth.



CARE

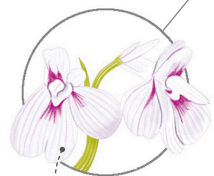
Feed monthly with a balanced liquid fertilizer during the summer and water moderately, to keep the soil moist. Water sparingly during winter.



I will fascinate you

I have the heartwarming ability to fold my leaves upward in the evening as if I am praying.

I can do this because of a hingelike structure at the base of my leaves, which is triggered at night when my leaves drain of water. You may hear me make a rustling sound at the same time.



My rare flowers may appear in spring, usually in pairs



I'm a work of art

My elegantly patterned leaves are also often red underneath—you can catch a glimpse of this when my leaves grow horizontally and fold upward at night.